

tools is contingent on the user, making spreadsheet software an indispensable tool for many people, from using it to do your homework to simply calculating the average balance on your bank statement.

Controls and tools

The default set that appears in the main menu is the most frequently required sets of tools in a spreadsheet application.



A typical ribbon consists of such buttons

▶ **Clipboard/Menu:** This

button is the shortcut to the Cut-Copy-Paste options from your clipboard. It may also include basic formatting options with which you can change the appearance of your workbook and worksheet.

▶ **Text formatting:** Since spreadsheets display numerical data associated with variables in the form of text, there exist basic tools for altering text. The Font options allow you to change the font type/size/colour/format (bold, italics and underline) and text highlight colour.

▶ **Alignment:** The next sub-component is concerned with how the text is oriented on the spreadsheet. Text orientation, Indent, Wrap Text, Merge and options for the vertical and horizontal alignment of the text within the spreadsheet cells are all grouped together. The Merge options are especially useful as they allow you to combine adjacent cells to create a better defined organisation of your data.

▶ **Numbers formatting:** Numbers included in any spreadsheet can require a wide variety of formats depending on their origin; for example, currency is presented in a manner different from weights and measurements. The Numbers menu in the Control bar allows you to set the formatting of numbers in the spreadsheet to their appropriate style as well as easily set the maximum decimal point value across the data set. These options may or may not be part of the default view but will definitely be accessible through the menu options.

▶ **Styles:** The manner in which the data appears in the spreadsheets will determine how easy it is to access, organise and manipulate. So more than just serving up “style”, the Styles options prove to be of great functionality. Different spreadsheet applications offer varying degrees of flexibility to alter the worksheet style, but basic features such as setting up a group of cells as a table or colour coding them is almost always included.